Flownet

An AI-native open social network. You choose the algorithm, you own your data, and creators grow with the network.

01 — THE REAL QUESTION

Is a better Steemit *enough?*

Steemit − ~~Token voting~~ + AI feeds + Personal storage + Open protocol =

not yet a unicorn

Most of these pieces already exist in Bluesky, Mastodon, Pixelfed, Surf and Micro.blog. A list of features is not a company.

02 — THE BAR

Real innovation *passes three tests*

1

People feel it

The experience is clearly better than Instagram, TikTok or today's open social apps.

2

We can build it now

No waiting for future protocols, unlimited compute, or other platforms opening their data.

3

It compounds

As users grow, content supply, recommendation quality or the business network gets stronger.

03 — ALREADY BUILT

What open social *already does*

Product	What it already does
Bluesky (AT Protocol)	Third-party custom feeds through Feed Generators
Bluesky Attie	Builds feeds from plain-language requests (beta, March 2026)
Flipboard Surf	Feeds across Bluesky, the fediverse and RSS, plus creator microsites
Mastodon, Pixelfed	Open, federated posting and photo sharing
Micro.blog	Independent blogs on your own domain, with a social timeline

So “AI-built feeds” and “open personal sites” can’t be our advantage on their own.

Sources: PCWorld (Mar 30, 2026); Dataconomy (Apr 3, 2026); AT Protocol docs

04 — OUR THESIS

Find. Own. *Flow.*

We won’t build another social blockchain. We will redesign how work is discovered, how creators own their audience, and how value moves across the open web.

FIND · discovery OWN · audience FLOW · value

05 — SIX INNOVATIONS

Where we *focus*

01 TOP PRIORITY

Personal AI Algorithm

Describe your taste in plain language. The feed keeps learning from your feedback.

02

Open Creator Discovery

Find great work without following anyone first, across permitted sites and open networks.

03

Portable Creator Identity

Your site, original work, posts and followers live in your own data space.

04

Algorithm Marketplace

Feeds can be subscribed to, cloned and remixed. Great curators run their own channels.

05

Discovery-to-Revenue

Creators see which feeds brought new followers, email subscribers and sales.

06

User-Controlled Trust

Choose credibility levels, sources, AI-content rules and moderation services.

06 — DIFFERENTIATION

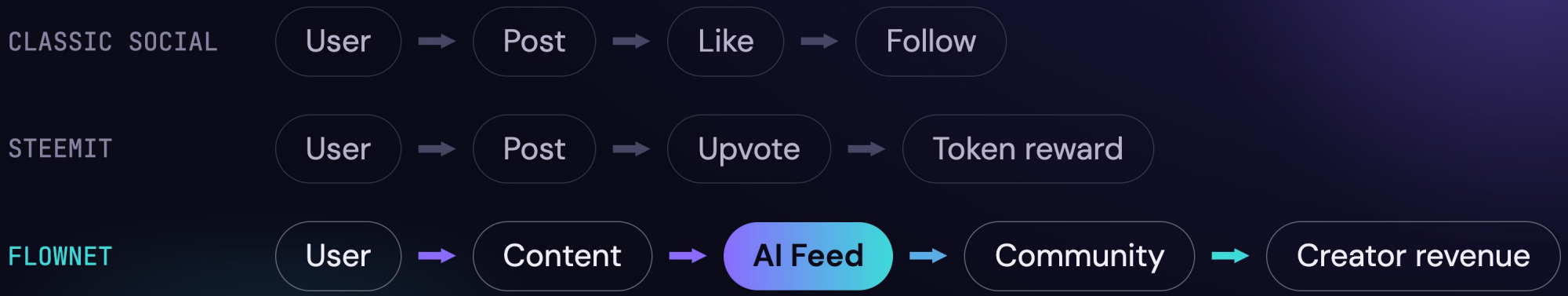
The edge is in *the combinations*

Combination	Why it matters	Biggest challenge
AI that understands taste + discovery across the open web	Closer to real taste than keywords or topic follows	Content rights, recall quality, ranking cost
Data ownership + measurable creator growth	Turns decentralization into real creator income	Attribution, proven growth, willingness to pay
User-controlled algorithms + a curator economy	Turns recommendation into a product people share and run	Feed quality, cold start, revenue sharing

Being first isn't what creates value. Each piece exists somewhere; the combination is what others don't have.

07 — A NEW SOCIAL OBJECT

Make the AI Feed *a social object*



A feed stops being a hidden ranking system. It becomes something people create, share, subscribe to and gather around.



SHARED AI FEED

Tokyo After Dark

Created by Alex · AI-curated photography feed

Independent photographers documenting Tokyo at night. Film, natural light, human stories. No gear ads.

Subscribe | Clone feed

08 — EXAMPLE

Meet the *algorithm curator*

- If Alex's feed reaches 100K subscribers, he becomes a curator with an audience.
- Photographers want his feed to find them; readers want to keep following it.
- He can run a channel, a community or a paid curation service.
- No buying organic rank. Sponsored posts are labeled and kept apart.

Concept example. Demand for feed subscriptions and paid curation still needs testing.

09 — PROTOCOL

FeedDefinition, a portable feed

```
{
    "type": "app.flownet.feed.definition",
    "version": 1,
    "name": "Tokyo After Dark",
    "prompt": "Independent Tokyo night photography",
    "sources": ["approved_public_sources"],
    "preferences": { "film": 0.9, "black_and_white": 0.8, "recency_days": 7 },
    "filters": { "ads": false, "ai_generated": "exclude_when_verified" },
    "ranking": { "relevance": 0.5, "freshness": 0.2, "diversity": 0.3 }
}
```

Versioned · Shareable · Clonable · Subscribable · Rated · Runs in compatible clients

Draft schema. The settings are portable; results can differ by index and model.

Three core *modules*

MODULE 1 · OWN

Personal Repository

Your identity, work and audience in a space you control.

- Personal site and original work
- Posts and portable follows
- Moves between hosts and clients

MODULE 2 · FIND

AI Feed Protocol

Feeds as portable objects people make and share.

- FeedDefinition records
- Feed runners on approved sources
- Subscribe, clone, rate, remix

MODULE 3 · FLOW

Creator Discovery & Monetization

Turn being found into income.

- Cross-source creator index
- Growth attribution by feed
- Subscriptions, sales, sponsorship

Reuse the open stack, *build the edge*

REUSE · AT PROTOCOL

What already works

- Identity: DIDs and handles
- Personal data servers (user repos)
- Lexicon schemas for new records
- Feed generator interface
- Labelers for moderation

BUILD · FLOWNET

Where our value is

- FeedDefinition and the feed runner
- Cross-source index (AT, ActivityPub, RSS)
- Taste model that learns from feedback
- Attribution and creator revenue
- Curator marketplace

Proposed split, to confirm with engineering. No new blockchain.

12 — BUSINESS MODEL

How Flownet *makes money*

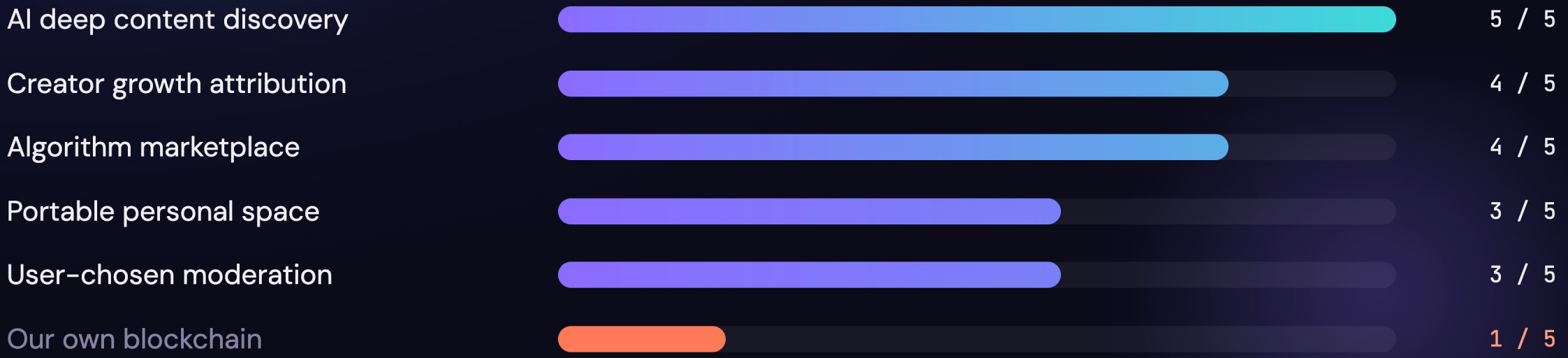
Every revenue line is tied to value someone can see.

Who pays	For what
People	Premium search, persistent tracking and advanced personal algorithms
Creators	Hosting, pro tools, growth analytics and commerce features
Curators	Paid channels and curation services, with a revenue share
Institutions	Vertical discovery tools for photography, education and research
Brands	Clearly labeled sponsorships, kept apart from organic ranking

13 — PRIORITIES

What we *test first*

Scored 1–5 on user value, feasibility, commercial potential and defensibility.



Strategic judgement to order experiments; not market research or benchmarks

14 — ROADMAP

Prove it *in three stages*

STAGE 1

AI discovery + creator spaces

VALIDATE

Do people keep coming back to their AI feeds? Do creators set up their own spaces?

STAGE 2

Attribution + monetization

VALIDATE

Does AI discovery bring creators real followers, subscribers and sales?

STAGE 3

Marketplace + open ecosystem

THEN OPEN UP

With real content, users and revenue, open to third-party algorithms, hosts and clients.

Each stage starts only when the previous one is proven. Dates to be set.

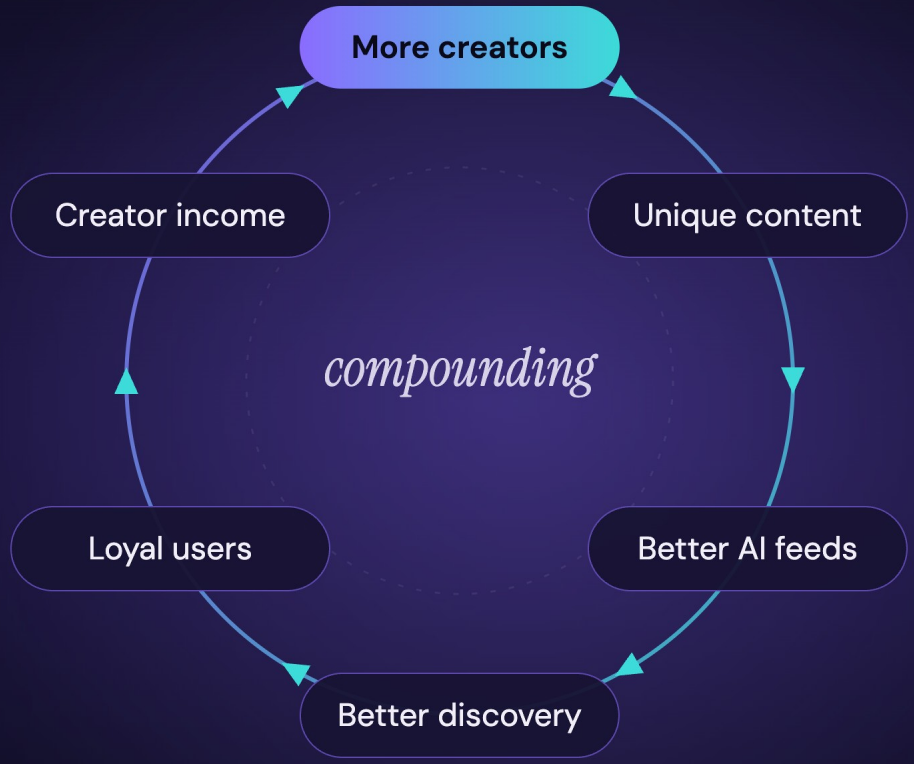
15 — THE MOAT

The moat is *a flywheel*

A chain or a protocol alone won't protect us. Network effects that feed each other can.

If it turns, Flownet becomes a discovery and creator-commerce network that spans the open web.

A hypothesis to prove with real retention, content supply and creator income.



CASE STUDY · THE FIRST VERTICAL

From one sentence *to a working feed*

THE PROMPT

“I want street photography by independent photographers around the world, especially Tokyo, New York and Hong Kong. I love film, black-and-white, natural light and compositions that tell a story. No ads, gear promotions or AI-generated photos. Put work from the last seven days first, with a few classics mixed in.”

A Personal AI Discovery Engine keeps collecting open photography in the background. Each person’s own algorithm then filters and ranks it. Posts always stay with their creators.

Six kinds of intent *in one prompt*

Dimension	What the AI should understand	How it runs
Topic	Street and documentary city life	Semantic search + image understanding
Place	Tokyo, NYC, Hong Kong first	Ranking weight + city diversity
Look	Film, black-and-white, natural light, story	Multimodal image scoring
Creator	Independent photographers, not brands	Source analysis + creator score
Exclusions	Ads, gear promos, AI-generated images	Hard rules + provenance checks
Time	Last 7 days first, classics mixed in	Time decay + content quotas

PHOTO FEED · 02 — PIPELINE

Compile the prompt, *don't just ask a model*

One model deciding everything is unpredictable. The prompt becomes rules you can see, save and export.

Switch clients, search providers or AI models, and your feed's preferences come with you.

01	Prompt	Describe what you want to see
02	*Compiler*	Extract topics, preferences, exclusions, weights
03	Search	Find candidate posts across sources
04	Filter	Remove anything that breaks your rules
05	Rank	Score and reorder for you
06	*Your feed*	Yours, explainable, exportable

PHOTO FEED · 03 — SOURCES

Where the photos *come from*

Source	Priority	Access	Role
Photographers' own sites	P0	RSS, Atom, JSON Feed, WordPress REST API	Core: the original source
Bluesky (AT Protocol)	P0	searchPosts API, later the Jetstream feed	Real-time discovery
Mastodon (ActivityPub)	P0	Hashtag timelines, media-only posts	Open social network
Flickr	P1	API; commercial use needs a licence	Photography depth
Wikimedia Commons	P1	Official API + per-image licence check	Classic archive
Instagram, TikTok	Not now	Only with official permission	—

Discovery keeps the author, link, time, tags and allowed image features.

Display uses authorized previews or embeds, and links back.

Follow a whole site, even if the photographer never joins.

Publicly visible is not the same as free to download, cache or redistribute.

Three paths *to the right photo*

PATH 1

Keywords

東京 ストリート写真 · 香港街頭攝影 · 35mm film · available light

Text can't decide alone: a Nikon billboard in the shot isn't an ad.

PATH 2

Image meaning

CLIP or SigLIP embeddings place photos and your prompt in one space, so a rainy black-and-white Tokyo street lands close to your request.

It can judge a film look, not prove a photo was shot on film.

PATH 3

Creator network

When one photographer keeps matching your taste, suggest following their own site by RSS.

They never need to join Flownet.

A few hundred candidates per path → merge · dedupe · review · score

Ranked on open, no live web crawl

PHOTO FEED · 05 — FILTERS

Hard rules, *soft preferences*

HARD FILTER · REMOVED

- Paid ads and brand promotions
- Gear promos, discount codes, shopping links
- Images confirmed as AI-generated
- Text-only posts with no photo
- No display rights: link to the original only

SOFT PREFERENCE · RANKED

- Shot on digital: stays, the look decides
- Brilliant, but from Paris: lower place score
- Shot years ago, posted this week: recent pool
- A 50-year-old classic: the classic pool
- Unknown photographer: no follower penalty

AI PROVENANCE · STANDARD (DEFAULT)

Drops confirmed AI images. Uncertain ones stay, with their source status shown.

AI PROVENANCE · STRICT

Only photos with solid evidence of real capture. Fewer results.

Signals: creator statements, C2PA, process evidence, model checks. No detector is proof.

PHOTO FEED · 06 — RANKING

A score *you can read*

$$S = 100 \times (0.25T + 0.25V + 0.15G + 0.15F + 0.10I + 0.10Q)$$



Likes and views are not in the formula. A photographer with 200 followers can outrank one with 2 million.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A Tokyo street photo, posted 2 days ago

T 0.94	V 0.90
G 1.00	F 0.67
I 0.95	Q 0.85

89.1 / 100

Starting weights for the MVP, to be tuned with real feedback

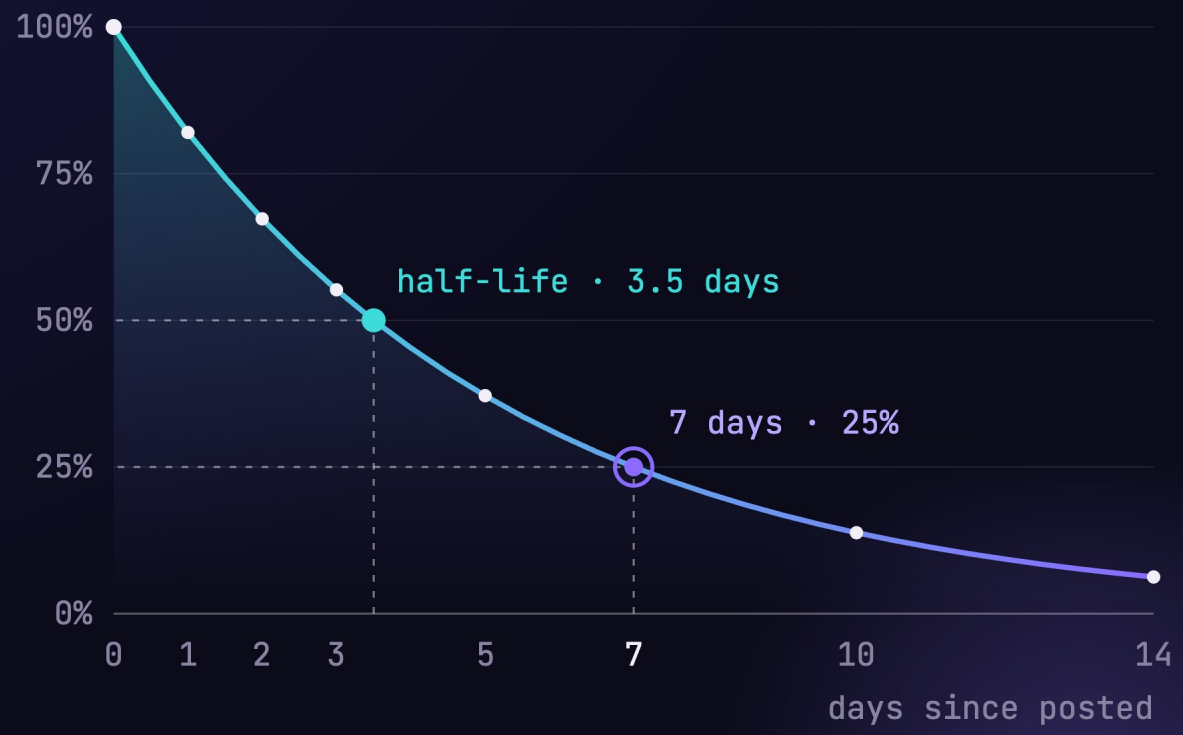
PHOTO FEED · 07 — FRESHNESS

Fresh first, *classics apart*

```
F = 2^(-d / 3.5)
```

Freshness halves every 3.5 days. After a week, a post keeps 25%.

On its own, this would bury every older work. So classics come from a separate pool, scored without time decay.



Freshness curve from the formula; not measured user data

PHOTO FEED · 08 — RE-RANKING

Not just *the top 20*

TIME MIX · PER 20 POSTS



PLACE MIX · PER 20 POSTS



- At most 2 posts per photographer in every 20
- Reposts appear once, with the original first
- Similar shots are grouped into one set
- “More like this” and “Less like this” reshape what comes next

Soft targets: if a city runs short, strong work from elsewhere fills the gap

PHOTO FEED · 09 — CONFIG

The prompt, *compiled*

```
{
    "topic": "documentary street photography",
    "preferred_locations": ["Tokyo", "New York City", "Hong Kong"],
    "visual_preferences": ["black and white", "analog film aesthetic", "natural light", "candid"],
    "exclude": ["advertisements", "camera gear promotions", "confirmed AI-generated images"],
    "ai_provenance_mode": "exclude_confirmed",
    "ranking_weights": { "topic": 0.25, "visual": 0.25, "geography": 0.15,
        "independent_creator": 0.10, "quality": 0.10, "freshness": 0.15 },
    "freshness_half_life_days": 3.5,
    "content_mix": { "last_7_days": 0.80, "days_8_to_30": 0.10, "classic_archive": 0.10 }
}
```

"More rainy Tokyo." The AI edits the config, not code.

Lives at yourdomain.com/feeds/street-photo.json

PHOTO FEED · 10 — STACK

A lean *MVP stack*

PostgreSQL with pgvector is enough to prove the core. No distributed search engine on day one.

Next.js · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · pgvector · Redis + Celery · Multimodal model · Structured-output LLM

Keep three times apart: published, captured and indexed.

SOURCES	Personal sites, RSS, AT Protocol, ActivityPub, licensed photo APIs
INDEX	PostgreSQL: URL, author, times, rights, metadata
ENRICH	Image understanding, cross-language tags, embeddings, ad and provenance checks
SEARCH	Full-text keywords + pgvector similarity
RANKER	Reads your feed config: filter, score, diversify
APP	Feed, follow, feedback, link to the original

Four steps *to a real feed*

01

Real photos in

Volunteer photographers' sites, plus Bluesky and Mastodon. Solid URLs, sources and licences.

02 · PROVE FIRST

Prompt to feed

Any photography prompt becomes queries, filters and weights.

03

Live feedback

"Love this, find ten more." Feedback becomes clear preferences you can undo.

04

Open protocol

Publish on your own domain, move your feed config, switch index providers.

WATCH BEFORE LAUNCH

- Positive feedback rate
- New photographers followed
- Off-prompt and duplicate rate
- Not the goal: watch time

PHOTO FEED · 12 — OWNERSHIP

The photo and the feed *are separate things*

ORIGINAL WORK	alice.photo/posts/tokyo-rain	Stays on Alice's own site, under her control
MY FEED RULES	mydomain.com/feeds/photography.json	Prompt, filters, weights and timing belong to me
RANKING PROVIDER	any compatible service	Switch providers; nobody has to republish

If a photographer who never joined Flownet is found by someone in another country through a plain-language feed, without handing over the original work, the architecture has proven its core value.

Same rules can return different results on different providers. Openness means your rules travel.

IF WE GET THIS RIGHT

FOR PEOPLE

"I tell the AI what I want to see, and it finds great work across the open web."

FOR CREATORS

"I reach new audiences, keep my identity and earn, without depending on one platform's algorithm."

Let it *flow.*

[website] · [X handle] · [email]